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Technology

The technology layer — signalling, power, guideway and automation — and why Taipei runs several of each.

Taipei operates two incompatible medium-capacity systems, several signalling generations, rubber-tyred and steel-wheel running, and both third-rail and overhead power. Nothing in English explains why, and the answer is mostly history — procurement decisions whose consequences outlived the contracts that made them. The Matra dispute [\[/rail/history/matra-dispute/\]](/rail/history/matra-dispute/) is the opening chapter of that story; this is where the technical threads get their own pages.

Coming: signalling (fixed-block to CBTC, and who supplied what), power supply, guideway families, and automation grades. Each will be written against primary engineering sources, not summarised from encyclopedias.

1 entry

Three numbering systems on one line

BR Wenhua Line

Every Wenhua station has two numbers. On the southern half they run in opposite directions, and the northern half uses a different series again — because the line was built as two projects and a station was added to one of them late.

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Station names, codes and sequence from TDX Transport Data eXchange, Ministry of Transportation and Communications, operators TRTC, NTMC, and TYMC. Government open data. Retrieved 2026-08-10; source last updated 2020-01-31. The 12 Sanying station records absent from TDX are sourced directly to New Taipei Metro and government publications on their pages. Provenance.